LBW appeal, I set about the bowling attack with purpose and managed to score 196 runs with one ball of our 50-over innings remaining. One more six would bring up my double hundred but I was caught on the boundary; even so, we won the game and the 196 remains an Affies record.

Over a four-year period, Affies played 103 matches and lost 11 – not bad. I had scored a total of 1 839 runs, but largely played second fiddle to Faf, who had scored a remarkable 3 190 runs.

Deon Botes was the first coach to make me think about my batting technique, about how to hold the bat, how to stand at the crease and how to play my strokes; until then, having learned the game playing with my brothers at Mentz Avenue in Warmbaths, I was simply content to hit the ball as hard as possible.

At the same time, my parents felt I would benefit from additional one-to-one coaching and they arranged for me to work with Shane Gouldie, who was the Youth Director at the Titans. Every Friday afternoon, my mother would drive to Pretoria, collect me from Affies, drive me to Centurion Park for the practice with Shane, wait around, drive me back to Affies and then drive for another hour or so back home.

Shane certainly helped me with my batting, as well as with my wicketkeeping but, above all, he gave me confidence in my ability to play the game. It appears to me that, whatever the challenge, whatever the circumstances, everyone benefits from having someone who unequivocally believes in them. In my life, through my teens, as I was growing up and contemplating cricket as a career, Shane Gouldie filled that role for me.

So, in December 2002, almost five years after arriving and writing the Honour Code 100 times, I left Affies with a real sense of sadness. A group of us wanted to mark the milestone in our lives.

'What can we do?' one of my friends asked.

My brother Wessels had told me about a tradition of buying a trunk, filling it with various souvenirs of our time at Affies and then burying